

LETITIA YONDERHQ EDIT

Travel Radio Australia and this month we're catching up with Letitia Stephenson from Yonda and Yonda is a great company. It's travel related, you've got offices all over the place. Tell us a bit about more about Yonda and welcome to the program.

Thank you very much. So we are an AI engagement, customer engagement platform for tourism operators. We have staff or people all around the place from New Zealand, Australia and based in America and all over America and customers mainly based in New Zealand, Australia and North America and then a few in Europe as well.

So we're expanding quite fast. And how does it work? What happens with Yonda? You can help companies who are in the tourism space to streamline their AI and that sort of thing? The problem that we solve really for Yonda is that we help businesses with their sales and online conversion rates and then we help them save time and be more efficient with their business and we help them to gather and then actually use their customer data and we do that with our three products. So we've got an AI chatbot, an AI voice agent and then we have a reviews product and then within those three products we have a range of different features that help a tourism operator to be more efficient, sell more and to use their customer data.

So when people have a problem, you provide the software system for the chatbot right? Like when they ask a question it will say yeah I've got this in my database and it goes there first and then says do you want to speak to a person as well? Our chatbots are built on all the operators data. Yeah so there's a whole knowledge base in Yonda that it can go to or their large language model goes to to find the information and it's only based on the tourism operator. So because lots of tourism operators are a bit nervous about AI still and they think it's going to go and hallucinate and make stuff up.

So yeah we like to reassure them that there's quite a few guide rails around the the knowledge base for Yonda's chatbot or Yonda's AI agent. We use the same knowledge base for them and so it goes there, looks for the information. We usually aim about and we we achieve around a 90% success rate with the AI being able to answer all the FAQs that come through.

So that there's more percentage that don't or do need a human interaction. They get passed off or like handed over to a human agent when and where they need to and every business is a bit different. So we have some businesses that like to have more of a personal touch so they pass it over earlier then say another one that doesn't want to have anything to or like doesn't want to talk to someone and so that way we keep trying to keep them into the into the system a little bit longer if you like.

Well the AI space is really exploding now isn't it across in the tourism industry and what are your predictions for the next few years? What do you see happening and I suppose Yonda is

expanding as well. Our AI voice agents been live for six months in America but we've only just released it in Australia here and then we'll release it in New Zealand. We see this as sort of the start of sort of different lots of AI products and things that are going to come out in the industry space or in this operator space.

If I had to make a five, did you say five years? That's quite a while. Yeah no that's what I mean it's really hard to know what's going to look like in a year let alone five years so I don't know if I want to make that prediction. I think it's going to be really important how operators use their data, what they do with it, how it's structured to be able to be found by large language models and I definitely think that some like companies like ours are going to play a probably a bit of a more of a role and more of an important role in how making it easier for operators to be able to use their data and get it found in those large language models.

I was talking to another software AI expert here at the conference and she said the Stripe, the Stripe data is very important on websites now to allow the chat GPTs and all those to find. Yeah can you tell us a bit about that? But what we have found is that the large language models need quite long tailed like sort of detailed FAQs and like they read it on their off their pages. Our data from the chatbot and from the voice actually gives operators the opportunity to create those lists so we're finding that a lot of operators at the moment are like asking us and the data is in their dashboard for Yonder but they are asking us how what they can actually mine it, use it to put it back on their websites just to be found by the large language models so because no one reads it these days but yeah but the large language models read it so that's where that's where they're seeing the benefits.

Yeah that's like something like if you ask a question about XYZ travel company to chat GPT for instance it was it will look at that website and say right here's all the information I can mine and condense it all down for for you and and that's a great thing and that's going to be more and more and more how the whole world works. Now as far as you're concerned I'm speaking to Letitia Stevenson from Yonder. What I always ask is what are some of your favorite things I guess I suppose with the company you get to travel around what a few of the interesting experiences that you've managed to have recently in travel.

I've recently had the luck luck of traveling to Japan so we did a week in a ski fields out in Japan that was amazing beautiful country lovely snow if I had to choose a place in New Zealand it would be Wanaka it's beautiful go there they've got amazing food the lakes lovely it's just a beautiful part of our country. It would be Lake Taupo in the middle of North Island in New Zealand that's that's like my second home so definitely go see there. You're only a little bit biased there.

Well Letitia thank you very much for coming on board and how come how can people find out more about Yonder online? So just head to our website yonderhq.com and there's lots of information there around how to get hold of us or you can book a demo with one of our team and yeah just reach out that way it's probably the easiest way to get hold of us. That's great and

yonder is y-o-n-d-e-r-h-q.com and head over there and you can see all of their services whether you're in the tourism industry or just have an interest in AI and how it all works it's great. Thanks Letitia for being part of the program.

Thanks for having me.